

Helping New Zealanders Build & Modify Safe Vehicles

LVV Operating Requirements Schedule

Chapter 4 LVV Certifier Background Criteria

Version 13 | Effective from 1 March 2026



Approval Record

Signed in accordance with clause 1.3(5) of the Low Volume Vehicle Code of LVVTA, on by:			
New Zealand Transport Agency		Low Volume Vehicle Technical Association	
Name	Signature	Name	Signature
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Note 1 The first ten amendment processes to the LVV ORS (Amendment #s 1-10), carried out between August 2003 and June 2017, were made to the complete ORS document. From Amendment # 11 (which is Version 12, issued 1 October 2024), amendments are carried out to individual chapters. Note 2 Text highlighted in grey shows amendments that have been made subsequent to the previous version of this chapter, and a grey vertical stroke to the left of the text denotes important new or changed information (which may include information which has been removed).			

About the LVV Operating Requirements Schedule

The LVV Operating Requirements Schedule (LVV ORS), and its sub-set of LVV ORS chapters (the chapters) set out the operational systems and processes which enables the LVV certification system to function effectively. Whereas the *Low Volume Vehicle Code* provides the legal platform upon which the LVV certification system operates, the LVV ORS provides robust operational systems and processes to ensure that LVV certification outcomes are consistent, fair, transparent, and of a high quality.

Author, Publisher, & Owner

This chapter is authored, published, and owned by the Low Volume Vehicle Technical Association Incorporated (LVVTA). LVVTA is an incorporated society established in 1992, that represents a group of specialist automotive organisations (in turn representing approximately 150,000 members) who are dedicated to ensuring that vehicles, when scratch-built or modified, meet the highest practicable safety standards.

The information in this chapter has stemmed from work undertaken by LVVTA founding member organisations that commenced in 1989 and has been progressively developed as an integral part of the New Zealand Government's land transport regulatory system, by agreement and in consultation with the New Zealand Transport Agency (NZTA).

As a result, the considerable experience in specialist certification management built up by LVVTA and the specialist automotive member groups over the past several decades can be of benefit to members of the New Zealand public who also wish to build or modify motor vehicles.

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User's Feedback

This chapter is constantly undergoing an evolutionary development process in order to keep pace with changing trends and technology. To assist in this, LVVTA invites users of the chapter to engage in an ongoing consultation process with us by making submissions for any changes, additions, or clarifications which might improve the chapter, at any time.

Any submissions made via this rolling consultation process will be thoroughly considered, and incorporated, where appropriate, at the next available amendment opportunity.

Submissions should be made to submission@lvvta.org.nz with the name of this chapter in the Subject line.

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Chapter 4

LVV Certifier Background Criteria

Purpose of this Chapter

The purpose of this LVV Operating Requirements Schedule chapter (this chapter) is to explain the type of background that a person who would like to become an LVV Certifier needs to have. 'Background', in this context, refers to formal qualifications, but also, and more importantly, practical experience - together with the knowledge and expertise that this practical experience creates.

Because of the high level of complexity and diversity associated with LVV certification, this chapter sets out the:

- general appointment criteria – in particular the knowledge and practical experience – that any person wishing to become appointed as an LVV Certifier, regardless of which LVV certification categories are being applied for, must meet; and
- more specific appointment criteria for each of the various LVV certification categories a person wishing to become appointed as an LVV Certifier must meet.

This chapter should be read in conjunction with *LVV ORS Chapter 3: LVV Certification Categories*, and *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment*.

Italics are used throughout this chapter when referencing 'external documents' that are not part of this chapter.

Section 1 General Appointment Criteria to Become an LVV Certifier

1.1 Introduction

As with any certification process, the single-most important ingredient in achieving the highest possible level of safety outcomes is to ensure that the people who become appointed as LVV Certifiers have the appropriate general background, and in particular, have the specific background relevant to the LVV certification categories for which they are appointed.

1.2 The need for knowledge and practical experience

LVV certification is unique amongst all other certification types, in that there is no formal trade or profession to support it. Being a motor mechanic or engineer alone is a good platform, but it is not enough to equip a person with the necessary level of knowledge and practical hands-on experience required in order to make sound safety-related judgments within the complex and diverse world of modified and individually constructed motor vehicles.

Three decades of managing LVV certification operations have proven that, for the majority of LVV certification categories, the only people who consistently perform well as an LVV Certifier are those people who have built up a vast amount of knowledge and practical experience in relation to modified and individually constructed vehicles. This knowledge and skill is only achieved through working in an automotive mechanical environment, together with extensive direct practical involvement in the motor vehicle modification and construction sector. This knowledge can't come from anywhere else. There is no other way to learn it other than by doing it. The lessons learnt and historical knowledge accumulated during modifying and building motor vehicles creates a solid understanding of best practice in this difficult certification discipline.

Active involvement in the motor racing scene can also be an important contributor to the knowledge and experience required to become a good LVV Certifier.

Without this knowledge and practical experience, it is highly unlikely that the right safety-related decisions will be made when assessing a modified or individually constructed vehicle. There are potentially catastrophic consequences if an LVV Certifier is not able to recognise the essential starting-point principles of whether, for example, a vehicle is fitted with its original suspension uprights (and therefore whether or not the steering arms are in the correct position relative to the steering rack); or whether the steering arms are the correct shape (and therefore whether they have been heated and bent); or whether the disc brakes are original or adapted (and therefore whether the stub axle spindles might have been incorrectly machined).

In short, if an LVV Certifier is unable to determine that modifications have occurred in the first place, then there is no chance of ensuring that the modifications – safety-critical in many cases – have been carried out correctly and safely.

1.3

A passion for modified motor vehicles

Another lesson that LVV certification history has taught us well is that there is a clear correlation between consistently high-performing LVV Certifiers, and people with a genuine passion for motor vehicle modification and construction. Without the passion, there isn't the total commitment to the modified and individually constructed motor vehicle scene, that, over a lifetime, creates the necessary knowledge and practical experience required to competently assess such complex motor vehicles.

Consequently, there is a very small pool of people with the right attributes for LVV certification, and a much greater difficulty exists in identifying and training such people when the need arises.

The criteria in this chapter for application as an LVV Certifier has been developed over time, to eliminate the possibility of people without the necessary knowledge, practical experience, or high ethical standards becoming appointed.

1.4

The need to be 'scratch-built capable'

Ideally, a person wishing to become an LVV Certifier should have an exceptionally broad and high level of knowledge and practical experience so that they might be able, ultimately, to become appointed for the top-level LVV certification categories including LV1D (extensively modified and scratch-built vehicles), LV2B (extensively modified and scratch-built motorcycles), and LV2C (extensively modified and scratch-built trikes). If the available LV1A and LV1B 'bread and butter' work is spread too thinly across too many LVV Certifiers, the LVV Certifiers will not get enough work to stay sharp, and there will be insufficient work available to attract and keep the vitally important LV1D, LV2B, and LV2C Certifiers.

This balance is needed for reasons of both safety and geographical coverage, for both the vehicle modification industry and the enthusiast motor vehicle sector.

This unique situation is detailed further within '*7.2 Application of Geographical Coverage for LVV Certification*' which can be found in '*Annex 7 Related System Legal Reviews*' of the *Low Volume Vehicle Code (LVV Code)*, which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz

This expectation of being 'scratch-built capable' may, however, in some cases not be imposed, as circumstances will occasionally dictate that the most suitable person for a particular LVV certification category may not have the appropriate practical experience to certify vehicles of a particular era, type, or origin. This has to be taken into consideration to ensure that modified and scratch-built vehicles are being certified by the best-suited people, and this factor has to be carefully balanced against the challenges around geographical coverage. Although the LVV certification category system has been refined in this way, the objective is still, wherever possible, to start a new LVV Certifier with category LV1A, and work upwards.

1.5 General background requirements

1.5(1) A person wishing to become appointed as an LVV Certifier must meet general background requirements, which comprise the accumulation of:

- (a) a high level of knowledge and practical experience within the light motor vehicle industry (see Note 1 below); and
- (b) practical experience in light motor vehicle-related modification work; and
- (c) a strong interest in, and general knowledge of, light motor vehicles.

Note 1 The 'high level of knowledge and practical experience within the light motor vehicle industry' can be accumulated over a period of time during a person's career, and the person wishing to become appointed as an LVV Certifier does not have to be engaged in that industry at the time of making an application.

1.5(2) In addition to the general background requirements specified in 1.5(1), a person wishing to become appointed as an LVV Certifier must also meet the specific appointment criteria relevant to each LVV certification category being applied for, as specified in 2.2 to 2.14 (see Note 1 below).

Note 1 The vehicle and modification types which can be LVV certified under each of the LVV certification categories are detailed in *LVV ORS Chapter 3: LVV Certification Categories*, which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz

1.5(3) A person who wishes to become appointed as an LVV Certifier will undergo a comprehensive multi-step assessment process, including a 'Formal Assessment' (see Note 1 below).

Note 1 The assessment process applied to a person wishing to become appointed as an LVV Certifier is detailed in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment*, which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz

Section 2 Specific Appointment Criteria for LVV Certification Categories

2.1 Introduction

LVV certification is as diverse as it is complex. If one considers that LVV certification covers scratch-built cars, hand-built motorcycles, custom-built trikes, right-hand drive conversions, taxi-van seating, disability transportation equipment, electric vehicles, and a host of other vehicle and modification types, it would be almost impossible for any one person to possess the knowledge and practical experience to certify them all.

For this reason, all of the possible vehicle and modification types have been broken down into a number of different 'LVV certification categories', for which an LVV Certifier may be appointed. An LVV Certifier may be appointed for just one LVV certification category, or multiple LVV certification categories.

This section sets out the specific knowledge and practical experience required for a person wanting to become an LVV Certifier for each of the various LVV certification categories.

The details of the vehicle and modification types which can be LVV certified under each of the LVV certification categories are explained in *LVV ORS Chapter 3: LVV Certification Categories*, which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz

2.2 Category LV1A Modified Production – Limited

2.2(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category ‘LV1A Modified Production - Limited’ must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years’ full-time practical industry experience in vehicle modification work, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out a variety of (primarily) mechanical modifications to vehicles, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.2(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.2(1)(b) is met.

2.3 Category LV1B Modified Production – Extended

2.3(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category ‘LV1B Modified Production - Extended’ must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years’ full-time practical industry experience in vehicle modification work, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out a variety of (primarily) occupant protection system modifications to vehicles, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.3(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.3(1)(b) is met.

2.4 Category LV1C Modified Production – Structures

2.4(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category ‘LV1C Modified Production - Structures’ must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):

- (i) had two years' full-time practical industry experience in structural motor body modification work, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
- (ii) carried out a variety of (primarily) structural modifications to vehicles, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
- (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.4(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.4(1)(b) is met.

2.5 Category LV1D - Advanced Modified Production & Scratch-built

2.5(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category 'LV1D Advanced Modified Production & Scratch-built' must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modification or construction relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years' full-time practical industry experience in extensive vehicle modification or scratch-built vehicle construction, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out a variety of extensive vehicle modifications or scratch-built vehicle construction, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.5(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.5(1)(b) is met.

2.6 Category LVRH Modified Production – Right-hand Drive Conversions

2.6(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category 'LVRH Modified Production – Right-hand Drive Conversions' must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years' full-time practical industry experience in converting a variety of vehicle makes and ages to right-hand drive, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out right-hand drive conversions on a variety of vehicle makes and ages, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or

- (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.6(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvtta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.6(1)(b) is met.

2.7 Category LVEX – Exhaust Noise & Gas Emissions

- 2.7(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category ‘LVEX - Exhaust Noise & Gas Emissions’ must, as a minimum:
- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
 - (b) be appointed for one or more LVV certification categories other than LVEX (see Notes 1 and 2 below).

Note 1 Existing knowledge and experience in exhaust noise testing or gas emissions testing is not necessary, as LVVTA provides full training, including the use of the relevant testing equipment.

Note 2 An appointment for LVV certification category LVEX can occur concurrently with other LVV certification category appointments.

2.8 Category LV2A Motorcycles - Modified Production

- 2.8(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category ‘LV2A Motorcycles - Modified Production’ must, as a minimum:
- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
 - (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in motorcycle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years’ full-time practical industry experience in motorcycle modification work, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out a variety of (primarily) mechanical modifications to motorcycles, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.8(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvtta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.8(1)(b) is met.

2.9 Category LV2B Motorcycles – Advanced Modified Production & Scratch-built

- 2.9(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category ‘LV2B Motorcycles – Advanced Modified Production & Scratch-built’ must, as a minimum:
- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
 - (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in motorcycle modification or construction relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):

- (i) had two years' full-time practical industry experience in extensive motorcycle modification or scratch-built motorcycle construction, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
- (ii) carried out a variety of extensive motorcycle modifications or scratch-built motorcycle construction, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
- (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.9(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.9(1)(b) is met.

2.10 Category LV2C Trikes – Advanced Modified Production & Scratch-built

2.10(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category 'LV2C Trikes – Advanced Modified Production & Scratch-built' must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
 - (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in trike modification or construction relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years' full-time practical industry experience in extensive trike modifications or scratch-built trike construction, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out a variety of extensive trike modifications or scratch-built trike construction, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.10(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent;
- and
- (c) possess a high level of knowledge and practical experience in car components and systems as they relate to trike construction (see Notes 1 and 2 below).

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.10(1)(b) and (c) is met.

Note 2 Many trikes incorporate car components and systems – such as an OEM car independent rear suspension and differential assembly. Accordingly, 2.10(1)(c) requires that an LV2C Certifier must have the necessary car-related experience and knowledge to enable these aspects of trikes to be correctly LVV certified.

2.11 Category LV3A Disability Adaptation – Limited

2.11(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category 'LV3A Disability Adaptation - Limited' must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and

- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years' full-time practical industry experience in vehicle adaptations for people with disabilities, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out a variety of vehicle adaptations for people with disabilities, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.11(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.11(1)(b) is met.

2.12 Category LV3B Disability Adaptation – Structures

2.12(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category 'LV3B Disability Adaptation - Structures' must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Note 1 below):
 - (i) had two years' full-time practical industry experience in disability adaptation-related vehicle structure modifications, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (ii) carried out a variety of disability adaptation-related vehicle structure modifications, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
 - (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.12(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1 The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment* (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.12(1)(b) is met.

2.13 Category LV4 - Electric & Hybrid Vehicles

2.13(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category 'LV4 – Electric & Hybrid Vehicles' must, as a minimum:

- (a) meet the general background requirements specified in 1.5; and
- (b) possess an industry-expert level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category, as a result of either having (see Notes 1 and 2 below):
 - (i) had two years' full-time practical experience in the modification of vehicles with electric power, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or

- (ii) carried out a variety of modifications to electric vehicles, incorporating significant complexity and wide-ranging diversity; or
- (iii) accumulated experience in an alternative way to 2.13(1)(b)(i) or (ii) but which is determined to be entirely relevant and equivalent.

Note 1	The LVV Certifier Pre-assessment specified in <i>LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment</i> (which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz) will determine whether the knowledge and experience criteria required by 2.13(1)(b) is met.
Note 2	Category LV4 applies to modifications to electric vehicles. Where an Internal Combustion Engine vehicle is converted to electric power, an LVV Certifier with the appropriate LVV certification category (usually LV1A and/or LV1C) will need to be involved. For specific information on this, refer to <i>LVV ORS Chapter 3: LVV Certification Categories</i> , which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz

2.14 Category LVAC – LVV Authority Card

2.14(1) A person applying to become appointed to certify under LVV certification category 'LVAC – LVV Authority Card' must (see Notes 1 and 2 below):

- (a) be the approved representative of the organisation authorised by *Annex 3* of the *LVV Code* to issue LVV Authority Cards for specific purposes; and
- (b) provide written confirmation from the President or Chief Executive of the association responsible for the administration of the Authority Card, of that organisation's endorsement of the Applicant.

Note 1	Because an LVV Certifier appointed for LVV certification category LVAC is effectively just performing an administrative function, many of the processes, requirements, and costs specified in this chapter will not apply.
Note 2	More detailed information on the LVV Authority Card system can be found in <i>LVV ORS Chapter 12: LVV Certification Plates & Labels</i> , which is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz

Section 3 Additional Categories for Existing LVV Certifiers

3.1 Introduction

The criteria for appointment of additional LVV certification categories for an existing LVV Certifier is, in terms of background knowledge and practical experience, fundamentally the same as that for a new Applicant.

There are, however, additional considerations relative to an existing LVV Certifier's certification performance history, detailed in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application and Appointment*.

3.2 Criteria for appointment for additional LVV certification categories

3.2(1) An existing LVV Certifier applying to become appointed for an LVV certification category additional to that for which they are already appointed, must:

- (a) possess an appropriate level of knowledge and practical experience in vehicle modifications relevant to the LVV certification category being applied for; and
- (b) meet the appointment criteria for additional LVV certification categories specified in *LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application and Appointment* (see Note 1 below).

Note 1	<i>LVV ORS Chapter 5: LVV Certifier Application & Appointment</i> is available to the public electronically, free of charge, from the LVVTA website www.lvvta.org.nz
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Section 4 Appointment Limitations

4.1 Application of limitations within the Notice of Appointment

Since LVV certification began in 1992, modified vehicles have become increasingly diverse and complex, with technologies and trends tending to become more and more fragmented.

Despite the many different LVV certification categories specified in Section 2, it has become vastly more difficult, particularly over the past two decades, to find people with the diversity of knowledge and experience to be capable of assessing the same modifications across vehicles of different types, ages, and origins.

For example, the knowledge and experience of an LVV Certifier who intimately understands building hot rods or older American and Australian vehicles using traditional components and systems won't necessarily translate across to assessing modifications to modern performance vehicles. Conversely, an LVV Certifier conversant with modern vehicles using complex electronic technology will often be unfamiliar with many aspects of the traditional technology incorporated within older vehicles.

The LVV certification system has to accept this challenge, and recognise that some people who could become great LVV Certifiers won't always be able to apply their knowledge and experience across all vehicle types, ages, and origins. This challenge can be catered for by appointing a person as an LVV Certifier who can provide a good service for a certain segment of the modification market, by ring-fencing, where necessary, the LVV Certifier's scope of operations via 'limitations' recorded in the LVV Certifier's *Notice of Appointment* that is issued by NZTA.

Any need for the application of 'limitations' to an LVV Certifier's *Notice of Appointment* will be discussed with the LVV Certifier during the assessment process.

Terms & Definitions for Chapter 4

Certify	is, as defined in the <i>Land Transport Rule: Vehicle Standards Compliance 2002</i> , to verify that a vehicle complies with safety-related legal requirements prescribed by New Zealand land transport legislation.
Disability adaptation	means modifications made to a vehicle to accommodate the specific needs of a person with a disability, particularly in relation to entering, being secured in, and exiting a vehicle.
Electric vehicle	means a vehicle which has a form of motive power derived from electricity, rather than internal combustion.
Hybrid vehicle	means a vehicle which uses more than one type of propulsion system, typically combining an internal combustion engine with one or more electric motors.
ICE	(Internal Combustion Engine) means an engine which generates motive power as the direct result of the explosive force of the combustion of a fuel and air mixture.
Industry-expert level	means a level of knowledge and experience held by a person who is widely recognised as being of particularly high standing within their respective field, and who others in the same industry are likely to rely on for advice.

Inspection	means the vehicle inspection process specified in <i>section 2.4, 2.5, and 2.6</i> of the <i>LVV Code</i> , carried out by an LVV Certifier during the LVV certification of a low volume vehicle.
Low Volume Motorcycle	means, in simple terms, motorcycles which are modified or scratch-built in small numbers, and includes individually modified or scratch-built motorcycles. (See also the definition for an LVV)
LVV	(Low Volume Vehicle) means, in simple terms, vehicles which are modified or scratch-built in small numbers, and includes individually modified or scratch-built vehicles. The full definition of an LVV is contained in the <i>LVV Code</i> .
LVV Authority Card	(Low Volume Vehicle Authority Card) means an LVV certification document, issued under the delegated authority of LVVTA, specifying alternative safety related equipment required to be fitted to a vehicle for special purposes, as defined in <i>Annex 5</i> of the <i>LVV Code</i> .
LVV Certification	(Low Volume Vehicle Certification) means the process specified by the <i>LVV Code</i> , by which the design of an LVV is determined to comply with any applicable requirements, and, in recognition of which, an LVV EDP is affixed.
LVV Certifier	(Low Volume Vehicle Certifier) means a person appointed by NZTA under the provisions of <i>Land Transport Rule: Vehicle Standards Compliance 2002</i> , to carry out certification of modified and scratch-built LVVs, as specified by <i>Part 2</i> of the <i>LVV Code</i> .
LVV Certify	(Low Volume Vehicle Certify) means the same as LVV certification.
LVV Code	(Low Volume Vehicle Code or the Code) means an LVVTA document which is incorporated by reference into the <i>Land Transport Rule: Vehicle Standards Compliance 2002</i> , and all applicable individual <i>Land Transport equipment rules</i> , that provides the legal framework to enable the LVV certification of modified and scratch-built LVVs in New Zealand.
LVV EDP	(Low Volume Vehicle Electronic Data Plate) is an RFID tag, in use from February 2021, fitted to an LVV upon completion of the LVV certification process, which when scanned by an NFC-capable device, displays details and photographs of the modifications and construction features on the LVV to which it is affixed.
LVV ORS	(Low Volume Vehicle Operating Requirements Schedule or ORS) means the document, incorporated by reference under the <i>LVV Code</i> , which provides LVVTA's operational processes and systems necessary to meet applicable requirements. The <i>LVV ORS</i> sets out the obligations and responsibilities of LVVTA, and the LVV Certifiers.
LVVTA	(Low Volume Vehicle Technical Association) is an incorporated society comprised of specialist vehicle associations. Established in 1992, its objectives are to represent the interests of vehicle modifiers and builders in New Zealand, and to ensure high safety standards for modified and scratch-built LVVs. The LVVTA owns and administers the <i>LVV Code</i> .
LVVTA TAC	(LVVTA Technical Advisory Committee) is an LVVTA-appointed panel of industry expert-level technical specialists, established to provide LVVTA with a very high level of technical support and direction on all technical matters relevant to the LVV certification system.

Mass-produced vehicle	(also known as production vehicle, or high-volume vehicle) means a vehicle which is manufactured in quantities of more than 500 at any one location in any one year for the mass market.
Modification	is defined in <i>Land Transport Rule: Vehicle Standards Compliance 2002</i>) to change a vehicle from its original state by altering, substituting, adding or removing any structure, system, component or equipment, but does not include repair. 'Modified' and 'modification' have corresponding meanings.
Modified Production (LVV)	means, in simple terms, a vehicle which, while modified, maintains a sufficient percentage of body or chassis from one primary mass-produced vehicle that it can still be considered to be that vehicle. The full legal definition of a Modified Production LVV is complex and currently under review, and will be incorporated within the <i>LVV Code</i> once revised.
Motor vehicle	is as defined in <i>Land Transport Rule: Vehicle Standards Compliance 2002</i> .
NoA	(Notice of Appointment), means the contract which exists between an LVV Certifier and NZTA, that provides an LVV Certifier with the authorisation to carry out LVV certification on behalf of NZTA, and which outlines the terms, conditions, and obligations of the appointment.
NFC	(Near Field Communication) means a short-range wireless technology, typically requiring a distance of 40 mm or less to initiate a contact.
NZHRA	(New Zealand Hot Rod Association) is an organisation which administers hot rodding within New Zealand, and is a founding member of the LVVTA.
NZTA	(New Zealand Transport Agency) is a Crown entity responsible for managing New Zealand's land transport system.
OE	(Original Equipment) means the parts and equipment used in the assembly process of a mass-produced vehicle.
OEM	(Original Equipment Manufacturer) means a company that produces the parts and equipment used in the assembly process of a mass-produced vehicle.
ONT	(Objective Noise Test) means a test carried out by an LVV Certifier to measure the noise level of a vehicle's exhaust system at a specific engine RPM.
RFID	(Radio Frequency Identification) is a technology which uses electromagnetic fields to automatically identify and track tags attached to objects. These tags link to electronically stored information, which can be accessed using RFID readers.
Right-hand drive	means that a vehicle's steering wheel and driving position is located to the right of the vehicle's longitudinal centreline.
Scratch-built (LVV)	means, in simple terms, an LVV which has been individually constructed from unrelated components, or a mass-produced vehicle which has been modified to such an extent that it can no longer be considered to be a modified mass-produced vehicle. The full legal definition of a scratch-built LVV is currently under review, and will be incorporated within the <i>LVV Code</i> once revised.
Structure	means the elements of a vehicle which are critical to the strength, rigidity, steering and suspension geometry, and crashworthiness of the vehicle.

Stub axle spindle	(also known as a pin or axle) means the machined section of a stub axle which the hub bearings within a suspension assembly run on.
Trike	means, usually, a Class LE motor-tricycle (three-wheeled motor vehicle), as defined in <i>Land Transport Rule: Vehicle Standards Compliance 2002</i> .
Wide-ranging diversity	In the context of this chapter, a broad array of dissimilar vehicles modified by an individual, using a variety of skillsets.
